

The Scholarship Interview

Genre: Drama

Age Range: 16-25

Characters

ZARA (19) - Scholarship applicant.

MR. KHALO (40s) - Interviewer.

Scene Description

Zara is in the final interview for a scholarship she desperately needs. Mr. Khalo challenges her motivations and past, forcing her to defend why she deserves a future.

MR. KHALO: Why this school?

ZARA: Because it's my only way out.

MR. KHALO: That's not an answer we accept.

ZARA: Then you're asking the wrong people.

MR. KHALO: Tell me about your background.

ZARA: It's complicated.

MR. KHALO: Try anyway.

ZARA: I worked three jobs last year.

MR. KHALO: That's not listed here.

ZARA: I didn't think it mattered.

MR. KHALO: Everything matters in this room.

(Beat)

ZARA: I can do the work.

MR. KHALO: Everyone says that.

ZARA: I'm still here.

MR. KHALO: That's not proof.

ZARA: It is for me.

(Beat)

MR. KHALO: Why not give up?

ZARA: Because nothing changes if I do.

MR. KHALO: And if you fail?

ZARA: Then I fail trying.

MR. KHALO: That's not guaranteed success.

ZARA: I never asked for guaranteed.

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